



Multi-monitor launcher & window-tiling — User Manual

FCLX Studios · v0.1.27 · English

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1 • What is InstaDesk?

InstaDesk turns the tedious morning ritual — opening the same apps and dragging every window into place across several monitors — into a single click.

You arrange apps on a visual grid for each monitor, save that arrangement as a **Layout**, and from then on one **Apply** launches every app and tiles it exactly where you put it. You can keep many layouts (work, design, trading, streaming...), bundle several into a **Quick Preset**, trigger them with a **keyboard shortcut**, ad-hoc **Snap** a window into place, or **capture** a layout straight from however your screen looks right now.

Is it hard? No — the learning curve is quick. But InstaDesk is a power tool with real depth (per-monitor grids, custom launch arguments, browser tab groups, global hotkeys). This manual walks every feature; the in-app **Help** tab is the short version.

2 · Core concepts

Five ideas are all you need:

Monitor

You arrange one display at a time. The **Monitor** selector (left panel) chooses which; the **Display Array** shows how your screens are physically laid out. The **Identify monitors** button flashes each screen's number so you always know which is which.

Grid & cells

Each monitor is divided into a grid of **cells** (e.g. 6×6). You can set a different grid density per monitor.

Region

A rectangular block of cells you assign one app to. A region can be a single cell or a wide band — for example the left half of a monitor.

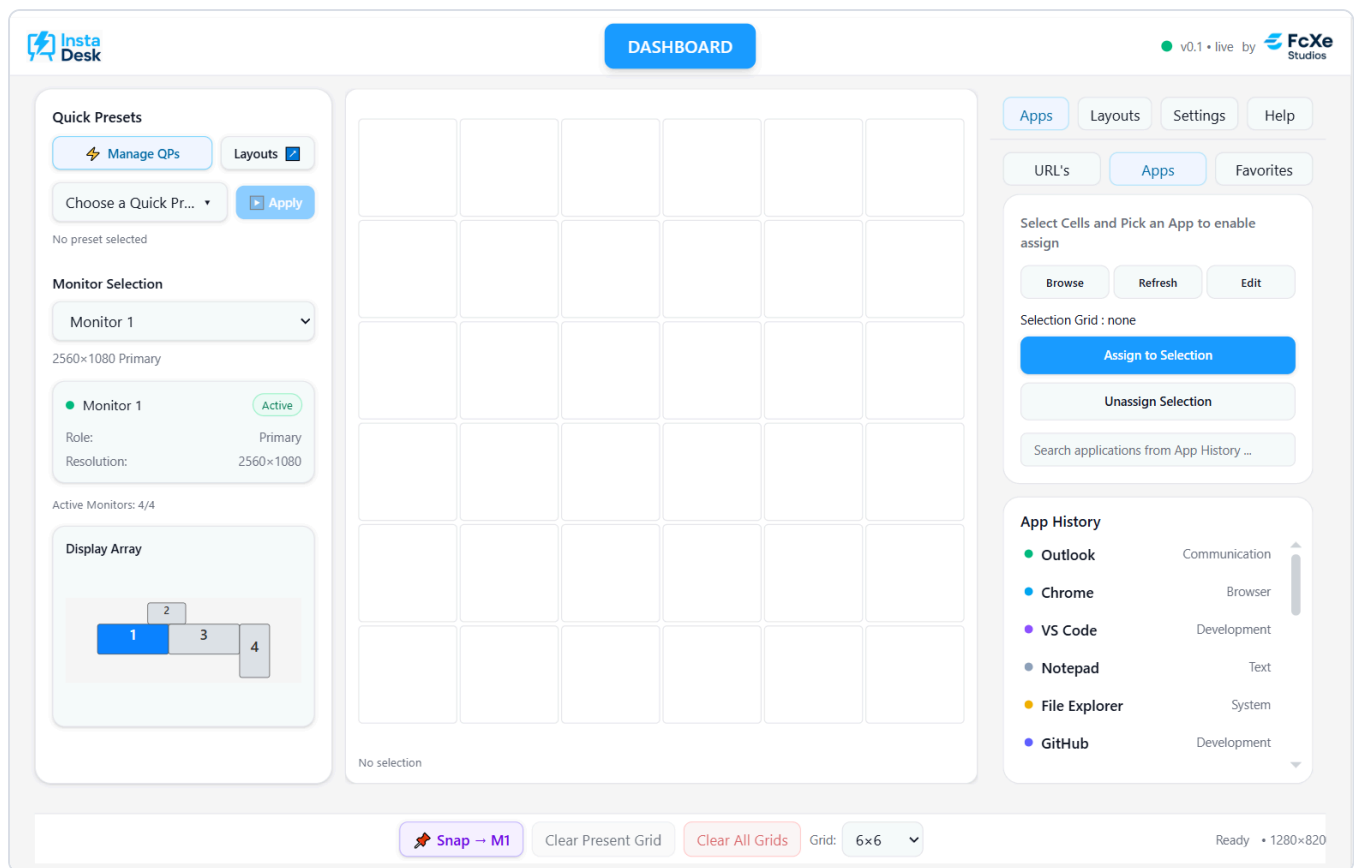
Layout

A saved set of regions across all your monitors — the heart of InstaDesk. Apply it to launch and tile everything.

Quick Preset

A bundle of several Layouts you apply together in one click (or one hotkey).

3 · The interface, at a glance



- **Left panel** — Quick Presets, the Monitor selector, the Display Array, and the **Identify monitors** button.
- **Centre** — the workspace grid for the selected monitor, where you select cells and see assignments.
- **Right panel** — tabs for **Apps**, **Layouts** (incl. **Capture current layout**), **Settings**, and **Help**.
- **Bottom bar** — **Snap**, the **Minimize all / Restore all** toggle, **Clear Present Grid**, **Clear All Grids**, and the per-monitor **Grid** size.
- **Top bar** — the InstaDesk logo, the current **version** (top-right), and the FCLX Studios mark.

4 · Quick start: your first layout

1. Pick a monitor in the left panel.
2. In the centre grid, **drag across cells** to select a region (say, the left half).
3. Open the **Apps** tab, choose an app (e.g. Chrome), and click **Assign to Selection**.
4. Select another region and assign a second app. Repeat for other monitors via the Monitor selector.
5. Open the **Layouts** tab → + **New Layout**, give it a name, and save.
6. Click **Apply** on the layout card — InstaDesk launches each app and tiles it into place.

The screenshot shows the InstaDesk dashboard interface. On the left, the 'Monitor Selection' panel shows 'Monitor 1' selected with a resolution of 2560x1080. Below it, the 'Display Array' shows a 4x4 grid of monitors. The central area is a 6x6 grid of cells, with the first 6 columns and first 3 rows (18 cells) highlighted in blue. Each cell contains the text 'Chrome'. On the right, the 'Apps' tab is active, showing a 'Selection Grid : 18' and an 'Assign to Selection' button. Below this, the 'App History' section lists 'Outlook', 'Chrome', and 'VS Code'. At the bottom, a status bar shows '18 cells selected, 18 assigned • 1280x820'.

In a hurry? Already have your windows where you want them? Skip straight to [section 8](#) and let InstaDesk capture the layout for you.

5 · The grid & assigning apps

Selecting & assigning

Drag across cells to select a rectangular region, then click **Assign to Selection** in the Apps tab. Use **Unassign Selection** to clear it. Regions must be rectangles.

Grid size (per monitor)

The **Grid** selector in the bottom bar sets the density of the *current* monitor — 6×6 for broad zones, 10×10 for fine control. Each monitor remembers its own size. Changing it on a monitor that already has apps asks for confirmation, since it re-shapes that grid.

Custom launch arguments

Give a cell its own launch arguments in the Apps tab — for example a folder path for File Explorer, so two regions open two *different* folders of the same app. This is how you place several distinct windows of one program.

The screenshot shows the InstaDesk Dashboard interface. At the top, there's a 'DASHBOARD' button and a version indicator 'v0.1 • live by FcXe Studios'. The main area is divided into several sections:

- Quick Presets:** Includes 'Manage QPs', 'Layouts', and a 'Choose a Quick Pr...' dropdown with an 'Apply' button. Below it, it says 'No preset selected'.
- Monitor Selection:** A dropdown menu showing 'Monitor 1' with a resolution of '2560×1080 Primary'. Below this, it shows 'Active Monitors: 4/4' and a 'Display Array' diagram with four numbered monitors.
- Grid:** A 6x6 grid of 36 cells, each containing the text 'File Explorer'. Below the grid, it says 'Selected: 0-6 × 0-6 • 36 cells'.
- Apps Tab:** On the right, there's a tab labeled 'Apps' with sub-tabs 'URL's', 'Apps', and 'Favorites'. Below these, there's a 'Select Cells and Pick an App to enable assign' section with 'Browse', 'Refresh', and 'Edit' buttons. Below that, it says 'Selection Grid : 36' and has 'Assign to Selection' and 'Unassign Selection' buttons. Further down, there's a 'LAUNCH ARGS FOR SELECTION' section with a 'Reset' button and an 'Apply' button. Below this, it says 'App default is empty. Whatever you type here is appended to the launch command.' and a 'Search applications from App History ...' input field.
- App History:** A list of applications: 'File Explorer' (System), 'GitHub' (Development), and 'Stack Overflow' (Development).

At the bottom, there's a bar with buttons: 'Snap → M1', 'Clear Present Grid', 'Clear All Grids', and a 'Grid: 6×6' dropdown. On the far right, it says '36 cells selected, 36 assigned • 1280×820'.

Clearing

Clear Present Grid empties the current monitor; **Clear All Grids** empties every monitor (with a confirmation). Saved Layouts are never affected by clearing.

6 · Apps, URLs & Favorites

The right-panel **Apps** tab has three sub-tabs.

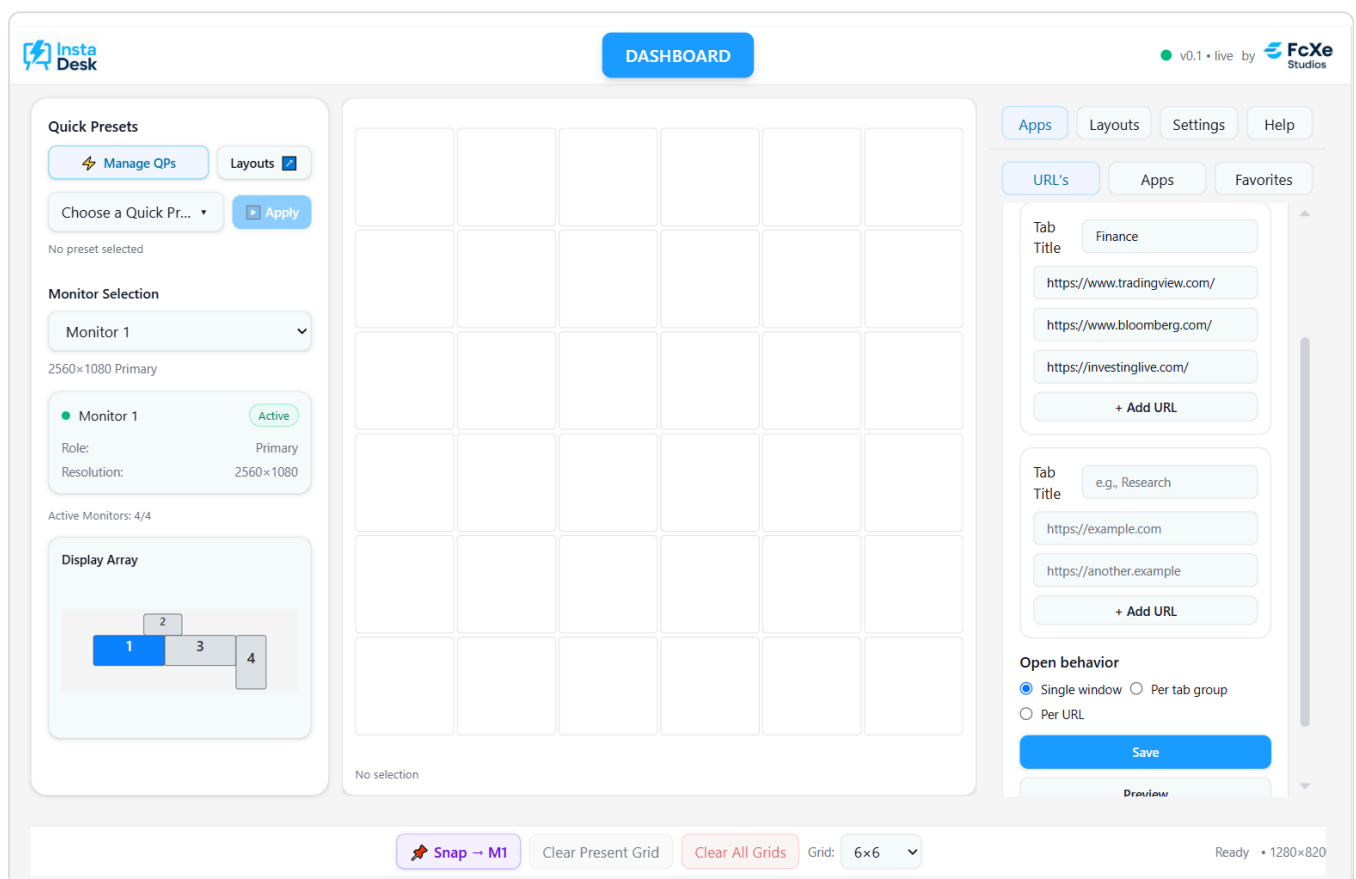
Apps

Pick from the built-in catalog, or click **Browse...** to add any program's `.exe`. Added programs are remembered in **App History** for reuse.

URLs — the URL Builder

Build a group of browser tabs that open together in their own window:

1. Choose a **Browser**. Click **+ Add Browser** to pick from the browsers detected on your PC, or browse for a browser's `.exe`.
2. Add a **Tab Group**, give it a title, and add the URLs.
3. Set the **open behavior** (one window, per group, or per URL) and **Save**. The group then behaves like any app you can assign to the grid.



Favorites

Keep your most-used apps and URLs one click away.

7 · Layouts

A Layout stores which apps go where, across *all* your monitors. When you save with **+ New Layout**, give it a name you'll recognise — for example “Work”, “Trading”, or “Editing”. You can keep up to **26** saved Layouts at a time.

- **Apply** — launches and tiles everything in the layout.
- **Edit** — reopens the layout on the grid so you can rearrange and re-save.
- **Rename** (✎) — give a layout a new name; its contents stay the same.
- **Export / Import** — share a layout as a `.json` file (its name travels with it).

If a saved app has no program or URL configured, only that one app is skipped on save (with a warning) — the rest of the layout still saves normally.

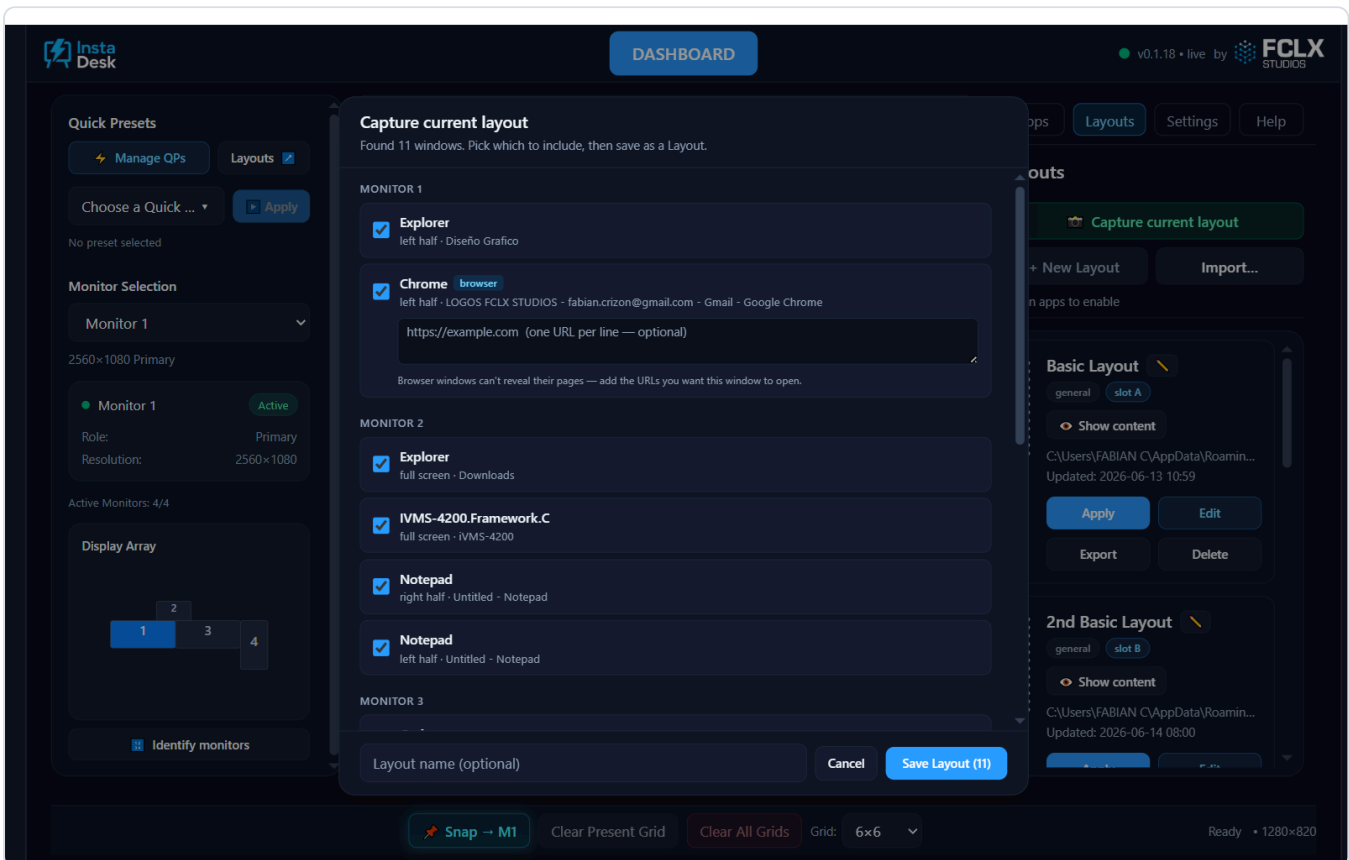
The screenshot displays the InstaDesk dashboard interface for managing multi-monitor layouts. The top navigation bar includes the InstaDesk logo, a 'DASHBOARD' button, and version information 'v0.1 • live by FcXe Studios'. The main interface is divided into several sections:

- Quick Presets:** Includes a 'Manage QPs' button, a 'Layouts' tab, and an 'Apply' button. A message states 'No preset selected'.
- Monitor Selection:** A dropdown menu shows 'Monitor 1' selected. Below it, details for 'Monitor 1' are listed: '2560x1080 Primary', 'Role: Primary', and 'Resolution: 2560x1080'. A status indicator shows 'Active'. A note indicates 'Active Monitors: 4/4'.
- Display Array:** A diagram showing four monitors arranged in a 2x2 grid, numbered 1 to 4.
- Layout A (general slot A):** The central workspace shows a 6x6 grid layout across four monitors (M1, M2, M3, M4). M1 and M2 each contain two 'File Explorer' windows. M3 contains a 'VS Studio Code' window. M4 contains three windows: 'iVMS-4200 3.6.1.3 Client', 'Crypto Utilities', 'Entertainment', and 'Varios'. Monitor specifications are listed at the bottom: M1 (2560x1080 Primary, 6x6 grid), M2 (1366x768 Secondary, 6x6 grid), M3 (2560x1080 Secondary, 6x6 grid), and M4 (1080x1920 Secondary, 6x6 grid).
- Layouts Panel:** On the right, a panel titled 'Layouts' shows a list of saved layouts. 'Layout A' is selected, showing its path and update date. It has buttons for 'Apply', 'Edit', 'Export', and 'Delete'. 'Layout B' is also visible below it.
- Footer:** A bar at the bottom contains a 'Snap → M1' button, 'Clear Present Grid' and 'Clear All Grids' buttons, a 'Grid: 6x6' dropdown, and a 'Ready • 1280x820' status indicator.

8 · Capturing a Layout from your screen

Instead of building a layout cell by cell, you can arrange your windows however you like — by hand or with [Snap / Drag-to-snap](#) — and have InstaDesk read the screen and build the Layout for you.

1. Arrange your windows across your monitors.
2. Open the **Layouts** tab and click **Capture current layout**.
3. A review window lists every window it found, grouped by monitor. **Tick the ones to include** (apps it can't identify are flagged and skipped).
4. For each **browser window**, paste the URLs you want it to reopen (one per line) — a browser can't reveal its own open pages, so you supply them here.
5. Give the layout a name and **Save**. It becomes a normal Layout you can Apply, Edit, rename, or export.



Good to know: apps that run as administrator (such as some CCTV clients) are identified and included. Windows you placed freely snap to the nearest grid region. Each captured browser window reopens as its own window with the URLs you added as tabs.

9 • Quick Presets

A Quick Preset bundles several Layouts so you can apply them all together with one click — ideal for a full multi-monitor workspace assembled from reusable pieces. You can keep up to **26** Quick Presets, and apply the first nine with a [keyboard shortcut](#).

1. Click **Manage QPs** in the left panel.
2. Create a preset and add the Layouts it should include.
3. Back on the main screen, pick the Quick Preset and click **Apply**.

10 · Snapping a window — Snap & Drag-to-snap

Snapping places a *single, already-open* window into a region — no Layout required. There are two ways.

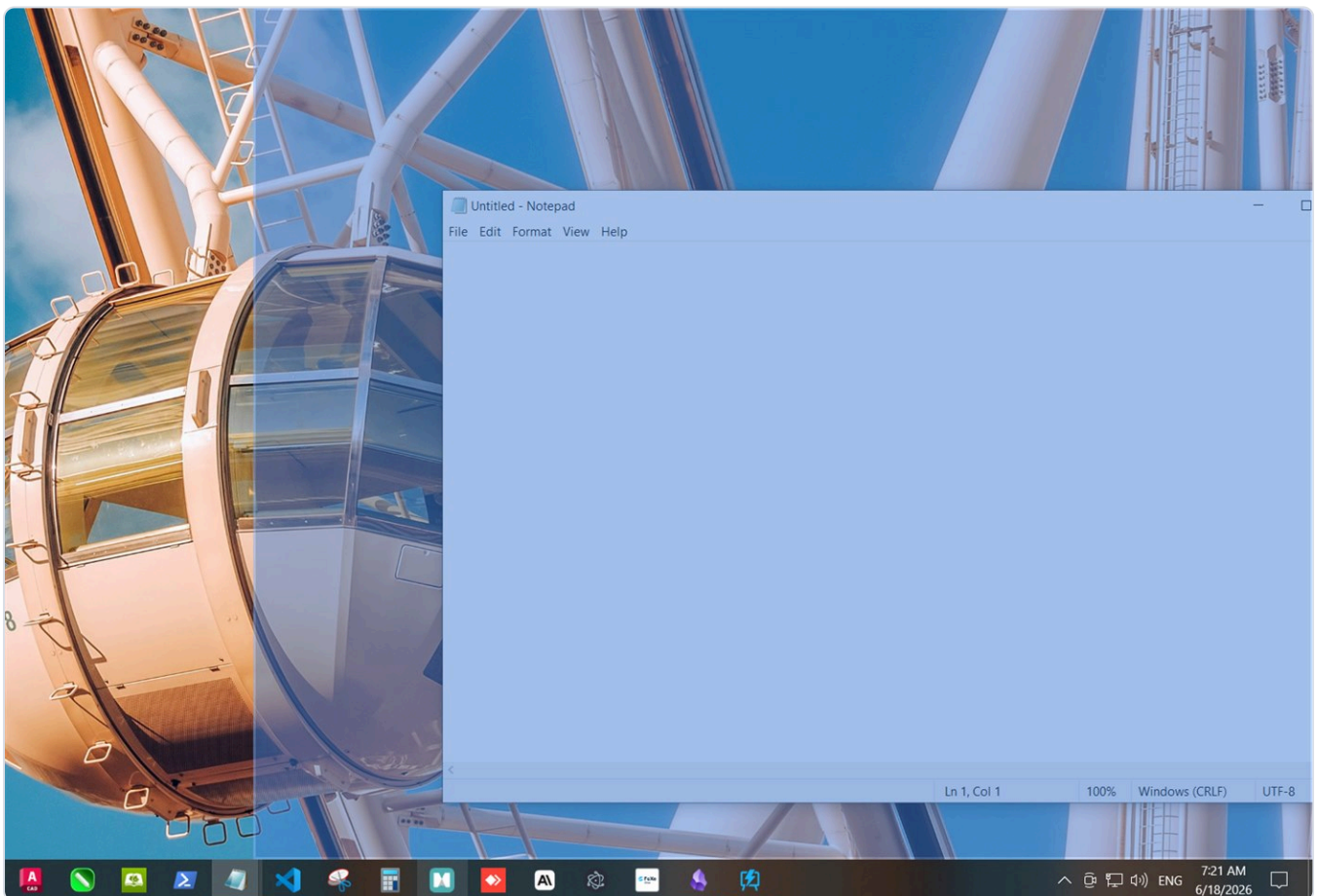
Snap (the grid popup)

1. Click **Snap** → **M1** in the bottom bar (the number is the active monitor).
2. A grid popup appears on that monitor.
3. Click a region; the window you last used snaps into it.

Drag-to-snap (hold Shift and drag)

Turn this on in **Settings** → **Grid & Snapping** → **Drag to snap**. Then, on any window:

1. Hold **Shift** and drag the window.
2. A translucent highlight shows the zone it will land in — **edges = halves** (left, right, top, bottom), **corners = quadrants**, **centre = maximize**.
3. Release to snap it there. Works on every monitor.



Some apps enforce their own position (certain CCTV / video tools) and may refuse to be moved.

Minimize all / Restore all

The bottom Snap bar also has a one-click toggle that works like a reliable “Show Desktop”:

- **_ Minimize all** hides every open window across *all* your monitors at once.
- Click again — the button becomes **▢ Restore all** — to bring each window back to the *exact* position and size it was in before. It does **not** maximize them full-screen; each returns to the frame it was in.

Windows that run as administrator (for example some CCTV clients such as iVMS-4200) are left untouched, and InstaDesk tells you how many it skipped.

11 · Global hotkeys

InstaDesk responds to these shortcuts from anywhere — even when its window isn't focused:

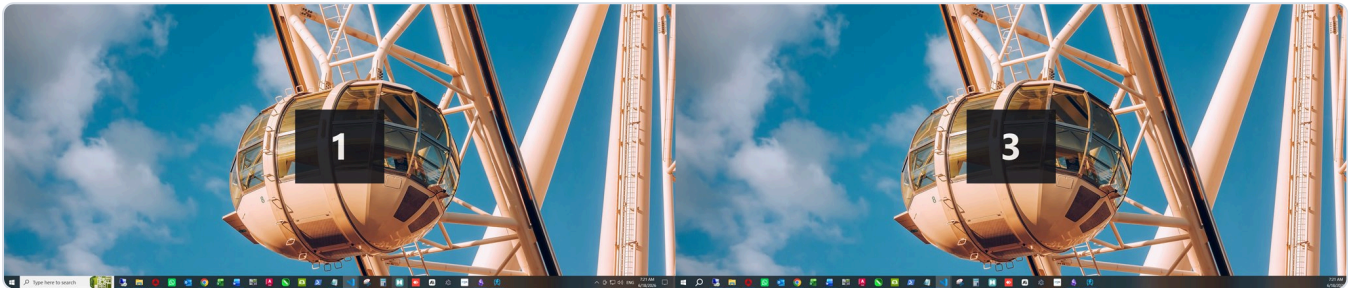
Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + Alt + D	Show / focus the InstaDesk dashboard
Ctrl + Alt + S	Snap the active window (opens the Snap grid)
Ctrl + Alt + 1 ... 9	Apply Quick Preset 1–9

The **Show** and **Snap** shortcuts are **rebindable** in **Settings** → **Global shortcuts** — click the shortcut and press your preferred combination (it must include Ctrl, Alt, or the Windows key).

12 · Monitors, Identify & the Display Array

The **Monitor** selector (left panel) chooses which display you're arranging. The **Display Array** beneath it shows your screens in their real physical positions, each with its number.

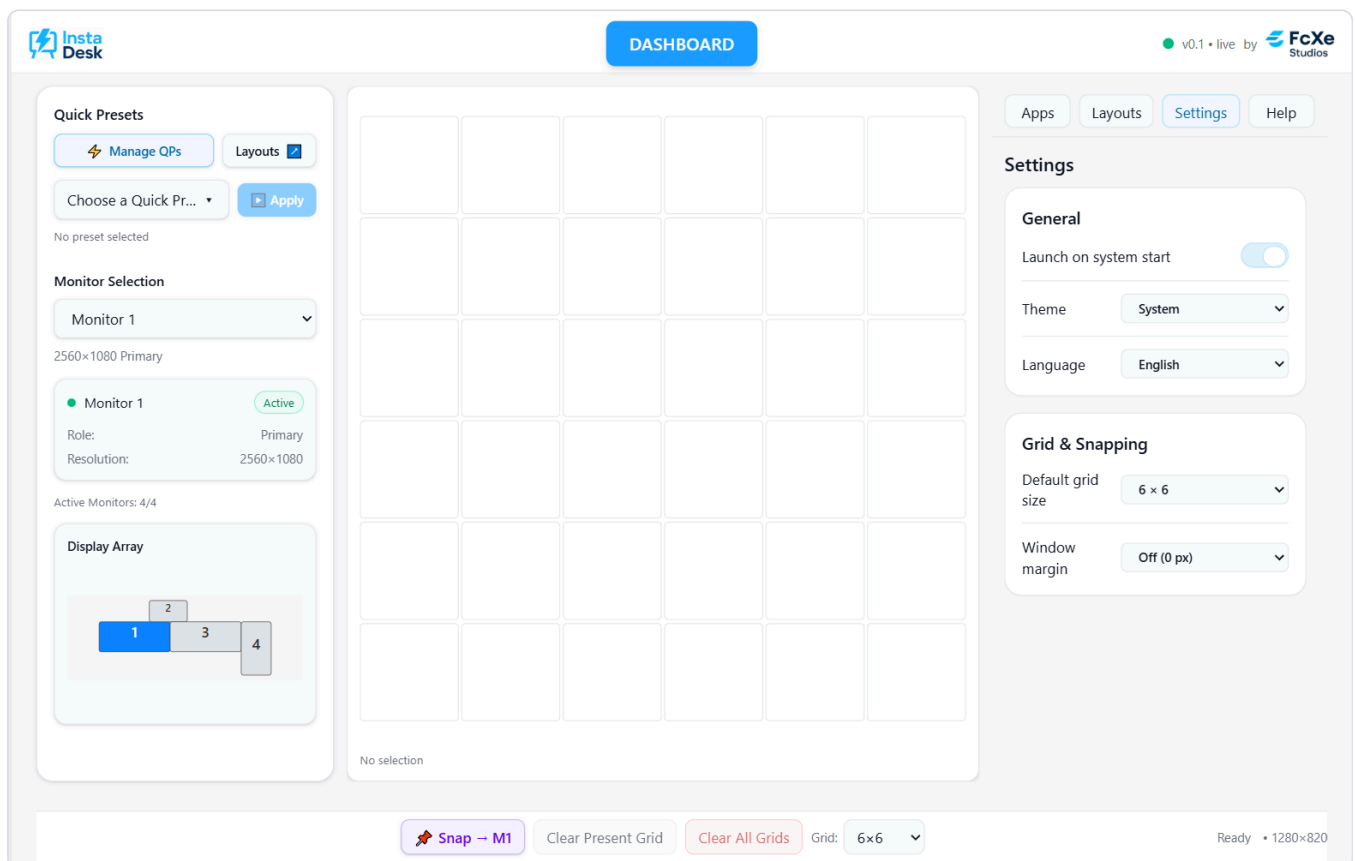
Click **Identify monitors** to flash a large number on each *physical* screen for a few seconds — exactly like Windows' own Identify. The number shown is the same one InstaDesk uses everywhere: the tile in the Display Array, and the monitor a Layout targets.



13 · Settings

The **Settings** tab (right panel) collects InstaDesk's preferences:

- **Theme** — Light, Dark, or System.
- **Language** — English or Español.
- **Launch on system start** — open InstaDesk automatically when you sign in (on by default; turn it off here).
- **Default grid size** — the size new / cleared monitors start at.
- **Window margin** — a bezel-aware gap so tiled windows don't sit under your monitor frames.
- **Drag to snap** — enable the hold-Shift-and-drag snapping described in section 10.
- **Global shortcuts** — view and rebind the keyboard shortcuts.
- **Updates** — check for and install new versions (see section 14).
- **Share anonymous usage data** — optional, on by default; sends only aggregate, non-personal diagnostics to help improve InstaDesk. No file names, URLs, or screen contents are ever sent. Turn it off any time.



14 · Staying up to date

InstaDesk keeps itself current with **signed automatic updates**:

- It checks shortly after launch and periodically while open. When a new version is available, a slim “**InstaDesk X.Y.Z is available**” bar appears at the top of the dashboard with **Install & restart** (or **Later**).
- You can also check any time in **Settings** → **Updates** → **Check for updates** — handy if you'd rather not wait for the automatic check.
- Updates are cryptographically signed, so only genuine InstaDesk releases can install.

The current version is always shown in the **top-right of the header** and at the bottom of the **Help** tab.

15 · Tips & troubleshooting

- **An app won't tile.** Some apps (certain CCTV / video tools) place their own windows. Close and relaunch them, or leave them out of the layout.
- **Only one window opens.** Single-instance apps (e.g. Outlook, Teams) open just one window; assigning them to several cells won't create copies.
- **A captured browser opened in an existing window.** InstaDesk forces each browser window in a Layout to open separately — make sure you're on the latest version if you see them merge.
- **A shortcut won't launch.** Windows shortcuts (`.lnk`) can't be launched directly — point to the real `.exe` in the Apps tab instead.
- **An app fails to launch.** Check its path in the Apps tab and use **Browse...** to correct it.
- **My added browser disappeared / opened the wrong browser.** Use + **Add Browser** and pick a detected browser (or browse to its `.exe`) so InstaDesk has its real program path.
- **A hotkey does nothing.** Another app may already use that combination — rebind InstaDesk's in **Settings** → **Global shortcuts**.
- **Windows land in the wrong place.** If you also run another window-snapping tool, it can fight InstaDesk and move windows after placement — close it so InstaDesk can do the job cleanly.

16 · Limits & capacities

At a glance, what InstaDesk can hold:

Item	Limit
Saved Layouts — multi-monitor	26
Saved Layouts — single-monitor	26
Quick Presets	26 (first 9 have a hotkey)
Grid density (per monitor)	4×4, 6×6, 8×8 or 10×10
Windows placed per monitor (one Layout)	up to the grid size — 36 at 6×6, 100 at 10×10
Monitors	every monitor Windows detects
Window margin (bezel padding)	0–16 px
Drag-to-snap zones	halves, quadrants, maximize — per monitor
URLs per group · Favorites	no fixed limit

Reached 26 saved Layouts? Delete one to free a slot, or combine related Layouts into a Quick Preset. Higher limits are planned for a future update if customers need them.